

Plans, Licensing & Enterprise Capabilities

GitHub Copilot

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Which plan is right — and how to justify the investment

Five GitHub Copilot Plans

From free for individuals to enterprise-grade for organizations

Free \$0	Pro \$10/mo	Pro+ \$39/mo	Business \$19/user/mo	Enterprise \$39/user/mo
✓ 50 premium reqs/mo ✓ 2,000 completions/mo ✓ GitHub.com + Editors ✓ Public code filter	✓ 300 premium requests ✓ Unlimited completions ✓ Agent + Coding Agent ✓ PR Reviews + CLI	✓ 1,500 premium requests ✓ GitHub Spark (Preview) ✓ Everything in Pro ✓ All advanced models	✓ 300 premium reqs/seat ✓ IP indemnity ✓ User management ✓ Usage metrics + Audit	✓ 1,000 premium reqs/seat ✓ SAML SSO ✓ Everything in Business ✓ Custom policies

Plan Comparison: Key Features

Side-by-side view of the most important capability differences

Feature	Free	Pro	Pro+	Business	Enterprise
Premium Requests/mo	50	300	1,500	300/seat	1,000/seat
Code Completions	2K/mo	Unlimited	Unlimited	Unlimited	Unlimited
Premium Models Access	Limited	Full	Full	Full	Full
Coding Agent (assign issues)	✗	✓	✓	✓	✓
PR Reviews + File Diff	✗	✓	✓	✓	✓
CLI + Terminal Access	✗	✓	✓	✓	✓
GitHub Spark (Preview)	✗	✗	✓	✗	✗
IP Indemnity	✗	✗	✗	✓	✓
User Mgmt + Usage Metrics	✗	✗	✗	✓	✓
Knowledge Bases + SAML SSO	✗	✗	✗	✗	✓

All plans include: Editors/IDEs, GitHub.com/Mobile, MCP servers, custom instructions, public code filter. Model availability: Free sees a limited rotating set; paid tiers see Claude Sonnet 4.6, Claude Opus 4.7, GPT-5, GPT-5.2-Codex, Gemini 2.5 Pro, and more.

Organization Management

Centralized control for teams deploying Copilot at scale



License Management

Assign and revoke seats centrally from github.com. Control who has access and manage costs with per-seat billing.



Usage Analytics

Dashboard showing team's Copilot usage, adoption rates, and productivity metrics. Track how effectively your investment is being used.



Policy Controls

Enable or disable specific Copilot features across the entire organization. Control which capabilities are available to which teams.



Audit Logs

Complete trail of who used Copilot, when, and where. Essential for governance, compliance, and security requirements.

Available with Business and Enterprise plans. Essential for organizations managing 10+ developer seats.

Privacy & Data Protection

Your code stays yours — comprehensive data protection guarantees



Not Used for Training

Business & Enterprise: prompts/code NEVER used for training. Free/Pro/Pro+ (effective 2026-04-24): interactions MAY be used to improve models unless you opt out in Copilot settings.



Data Protection Agreement

GitHub DPA outlines data handling measures for compliance with privacy regulations



Data Retention

Prompts and completions stored temporarily for abuse prevention only — then deleted



Telemetry Control

Admins can disable telemetry collection entirely across the organization



Public Code Filter

Detects and blocks suggestions matching public code (150+ chars). Enable in Settings → Copilot → Features

IP Ownership, Indemnity & Security

You own the code — and GitHub has your back on legal challenges

IP Ownership & Indemnity

- ✓ You own the output — generated code belongs to you
- ✓ IP Indemnity: GitHub defends you and covers legal costs
- ✓ Requires "Block matching public code" setting enabled

SSO/SAML + Audit

- ✓ Entra ID, Okta, Google Workspace integration
- ✓ Corporate credentials — not personal GitHub accounts
- ✓ SOC 2, ISO 27001, HIPAA, GDPR compliance tracking

AI-Based Vulnerability Filtering

Automatically blocks suggestions containing common security vulnerabilities in real-time before they reach developers:

-  SQL injection patterns
-  Cross-site scripting (XSS)
-  Hardcoded credentials & API keys
-  Path traversal vulnerabilities
-  Insecure deserialization

Copilot Spaces & Policy Controls

Knowledge Bases sunset Nov 2025 — Spaces are the new context management layer

Copilot Spaces (All Plans)

- ✓ Replaces Knowledge Bases (sunset Nov 1, 2025)
- ✓ Any Copilot user — including Free — can create Spaces
- ✓ Combine code, markdown, issues, PRs, file uploads in one Space
- ✓ Auto-syncs as repos evolve — Copilot stays current
- ✓ Share privately, with team, or publicly
- ✓ Access via GitHub.com or IDE (GitHub MCP server)

Organization Policy Controls

- Granular Access:** Enable/disable by team, repo, or user group
- Feature Toggles:** Control which Copilot features per team
- Model Selection:** Restrict which AI models teams can use
- MCP Server Policy:** Control MCP server access (new AI Controls tab)
- Data Residency:** Choose storage regions for GDPR compliance
- Budget Controls:** Set spend limits at enterprise/cost-center/user level

⚠ Knowledge Bases were retired November 1, 2025. Organizations on Enterprise should convert existing knowledge bases to Spaces using the migration tool in GitHub Settings → Copilot → Spaces.

Managing Content Exclusions

Prevent sensitive files from being used in Copilot suggestions and chat

Content exclusions prevent specific files, directories, or repositories from being used by Copilot. Critical for compliance — ensure Copilot never references repos with PII or sensitive data. Available for Business and Enterprise plans.

Impact of Content Exclusions

Code Completion: Excluded files won't have completions, and their content won't inform suggestions in other files

Chat Responses: Excluded content won't be used in Copilot Chat responses, affecting quality and relevance

Who Can Manage Exclusions

- Repository administrators, organization owners, and enterprise owners can edit exclusion settings.
- "Maintain" role users can view but not edit. Organization-level exclusions act as defaults, overridden by repo-specific.



Debug Tip: Hover over Copilot status bar icon to see: "Copilot disabled for this file by organization policy."

Configuring Content Exclusions

Repository-level and organization-level glob pattern examples

Repository-Level Exclusions

```
# Repo Settings → Copilot →  
# Content exclusion → Paths  
  
# Ignore a specific file  
- "/src/some-dir/kernel.rs"  
  
# Ignore files called secrets.json  
- "secrets.json"  
  
# Ignore all files starting with secret  
- "secret*"  
  
# Ignore all .cfg files  
- "*.cfg"  
  
# Ignore all files in /scripts  
- "/scripts/**"
```

Organization-Level Exclusions

```
# Org Settings → Copilot →  
# Content exclusion  
  
# Ignore all .env files globally  
"":  
- "**/.env"  
  
# In octo-repo: ignore kernel.rs  
octo-repo:  
- "/src/some-dir/kernel.rs"  
  
# In primer/react: ignore secrets  
https://github.com/primer/react.git:  
- "secrets.json"  
- "/src/**/temp.rb"
```



Org-level exclusions act as defaults. Repo-specific exclusions can override organization defaults. Use wildcards like `git@github.com:*/copilot` to match repos across any org.

Known Limitations with Content Exclusions

Important gaps to understand when configuring exclusions



IDE-Specific Gaps

Exclusions may not apply in Copilot Chat with @github participant in VS Code and Visual Studio. Chat may still reference excluded content through this channel.



Semantic Information Leakage

Type definitions and function signatures may still be visible. If you exclude auth.ts but another file imports AuthService from it, Copilot may still suggest AuthService methods because the IDE provides type information.



Policy Scope

Exclusions only apply to organization members. External collaborators are not affected by content exclusion policies — they may still see suggestions from excluded files.

Content exclusions are a safety net, not a guarantee. Layer with proper access controls and secret management.

Key Takeaways

- 5 plans: Free (50 prem reqs), Pro (\$10, 300), Pro+ (\$39, 1,500), Business (\$19/seat, 300/seat), Enterprise (\$39/seat, 1,000/seat)
- Business adds: enterprise security, IP indemnity, user management, usage metrics, audit logs
- Enterprise adds: Knowledge bases (index internal docs), SAML SSO, advanced policy controls
- Privacy: your code is never used for training, DPA available, telemetry control for admins
- IP Indemnity: you own generated code; GitHub defends legal challenges (with public code filter)
- AI vulnerability filtering blocks SQL injection, XSS, hardcoded credentials in real-time
- Content exclusions prevent sensitive files from Copilot — but watch for semantic leakage
- Policy controls: per-team access, feature toggles, model selection, data residency, retention